

TIPS FOR PRE-WASHING

- **You should pre-wash fabric** in the same manner you intend to launder the finished item in the future. For example, if you plan to wash the finished quilt on a cold wash cycle and dry it on a medium dryer setting, you should pre-wash the fabric in the same way.
- **You can serge or zigzag stitch** along the cut edges of some looser weave fabrics before washing to help prevent them from unravelling during pre-washing.
- **Always pre-wash large pieces** of fabric when you first buy

them, so you don't forget to do it when you work with them at a later stage.

- **When pre-washing fabric**, snip off a small triangle at each corner to prevent fraying. Washing small pieces of fabric in a lingerie bag will help prevent fraying.
- **Hand-dyed or Batik fabric** should always be washed and dried to set the dyes and keep them from running and fading. Use a dye catcher to help prevent the excess dye from spoiling the colours around them.

PREPARING FABRICS

After it has been washed, there is not much that needs to be done to fabric before you use it, but there are a few things to keep in mind:

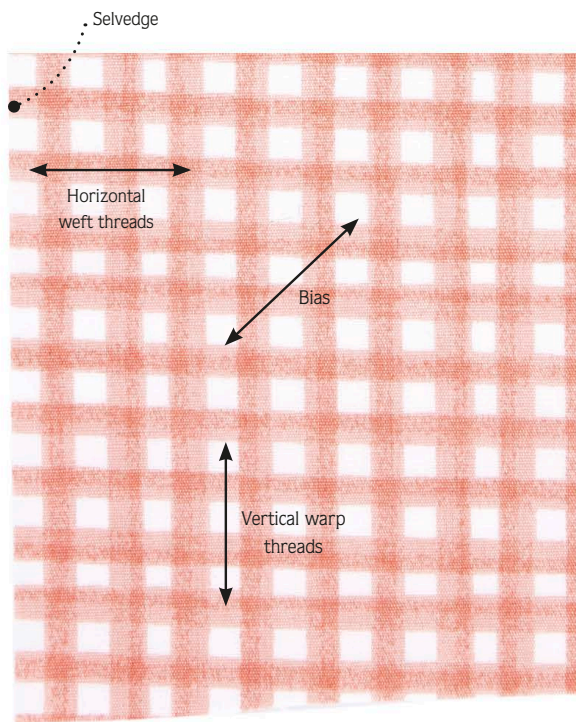
Drying If using a tumble dryer, dry your pre-washed fabrics on a medium heat setting and remove them from the dryer before they are completely dry. Drying a fabric completely can set the wrinkles firmly into the fabric and make them difficult to remove.

Ironing Iron the fabric straight out of the dryer while it is still damp. Starching the fabric can make the ironing easier and more effective.

Cutting Before you cut, check the straight of grain is true by checking it against the selvedge of the fabric.

TIPS FOR PREPARING

- **Cut quilt borders on the lengthways grain** to minimize stretching.
- **To find the lengthways grain**, pull the fabric gently along both straight grains. The stretch will be greater along the weft, or widthways, grain.
- **Try to position any bias edges** away from the edges of a block to minimize stretching and to keep the size of the block accurate.



Each fabric has three grains: the lengthways grain (warp), which runs parallel to the selvedges; the horizontal grain (weft), which runs perpendicular to the selvedges; and the diagonal grain (bias). The rigid edge on each side is called the selvedge. The bias should be handled carefully as it stretches easily, which can lead to distortions in the patchwork.